

Marketing Data Collection — from ad click to first deposit

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Step 2 of the weekly workflow in detail: which sources I pull, how I pull them, and how they are joined to player data



Every figure that reaches a dashboard is traced back to the source system it came from — no metric without a lineage.

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Data quality — what I check before anything reaches a dashboard

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Marketing data is the least reliable input in iGaming reporting. These are the checks I run every cycle and the failures I look for

Validation checks

- **Spend reconciliation**

Google Ads API total vs the platform UI vs the invoice from finance. A mismatch usually means a currency or timezone problem, not a data loss.

- **Timezone alignment**

Ad platforms report in account timezone, the DWH in UTC. Without alignment a Monday spend lands on a Sunday cohort and every daily ROAS is shifted.

- **Currency normalisation**

Spend in EUR/USD, deposits in local currencies. All values converted to one reporting currency at a fixed daily rate, stored alongside the raw value.

- **Affiliate deduplication**

The same registration can be claimed by two partners, or by an affiliate and a paid campaign. Deduplicated on the attribution rule agreed with marketing.

- **Attribution window**

Last click within an agreed window (e.g. 30 days). The window is documented — changing it silently changes every historical CAC.

- **Test & internal accounts**

Excluded by flag or by known email/IP pattern before any aggregation, otherwise QA activity inflates registrations and depresses conversion.

- **Consent Mode gaps**

Under GDPR a share of EU traffic is not fully tracked. I quantify the gap instead of pretending GA4 equals reality.

- **Bot & invalid traffic**

Sudden click spikes with 0% registration rate — checked per partner before the numbers are used in a payout decision.

- **Row counts vs previous run**

A partner report with 40% fewer rows than last week is a delivery failure, not a market trend. Volume is compared before the data is used.

- **Campaign naming consistency**

A renamed campaign silently splits its own history in two. Mapped to a stable campaign ID rather than to the display name.

- **Late-arriving conversions**

Registrations and FTDs keep landing for days after the click. Reports older than the attribution window are re-stated, not frozen.

Failures I look for first

- **gclid not stored at registration**

Paid traffic shows as 'direct'. Symptom: organic registrations suddenly jump while spend is flat.

- **Postback fires before deposit clears**

FTD counted, payment later fails. Commission paid on revenue that never arrived.

- **GTM tag duplicated after a site release**

Every event counted twice. Symptom: conversion rate doubles overnight with no product change.

- **Affiliate report in partner's timezone**

Month-end volumes never match the DWH. Always reconciled on a full-month window, not a single day.

- **Self-attribution by ad platforms**

Google Ads and the DWH will never fully agree — platform-reported conversions are not the reporting source of truth.

- **Currency mixed at source**

A partner switches invoicing currency mid-month without notice. Caught by comparing average commission per FTD against history.

What marketing and finance receive

- Channel performance dashboard: spend, CAC, FTD rate and ROAS per campaign and per affiliate partner.
- Partner payout check: claimed vs verified conversions, with disputed records listed separately.
- Funnel view: where users drop between landing, form and first deposit, split by traffic source.
- A written note on data limitations for the period (tracking gaps, missing partner reports) — so decisions are made with known uncertainty.
- Every number is reproducible: the query and the source extract behind each figure are versioned and can be re-run.